TROPHY TEST LAWS OF PADDLE PONG

Synthetic fixture for Trophy's rulebook scraper and index tests. Paddle pong is an invented game and every clause below is made up. This is NOT an official rulebook of any federation. Numbering follows the hierarchical style used by real law books so that the splitter is exercised on headings, wrapped lines, page numbers, a table of contents and a national byelaw box.

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2 THE TEST LAWS OF PADDLE PONG

2.1 THE TABLE

2.1.1 The upper surface of the table, known as the playing surface, shall be rectangular, 3.00 m long and 1.50 m wide, and shall lie in a horizontal plane 80 cm above the floor.

2.1.2 The playing surface shall not include the vertical sides of the tabletop; a ball that touches only a vertical side has left the playing surface.

2.1.3 The playing surface shall yield a uniform bounce of about 25 cm when a standard paddle pong ball is dropped on to it from a height of 30 cm.

2.2 THE NET ASSEMBLY

2.2.1 The net assembly shall consist of the net, its suspension and the supporting posts, including the clamps attaching them to the table.

2.2.2 The top of the net, along its whole length, shall be 16 cm above the playing surface.

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2.6 THE SERVICE

2.6.1 Service shall start with the ball resting freely on the open palm of the server's stationary free hand, held still for at least one second.

2.6.2 The server shall then project the ball near vertically upwards, without imparting spin, so that it rises at least 20 cm after leaving the palm of the free hand and then falls without touching anything before being struck.

2.6.3 As the ball is falling the server shall strike it so that it touches first the server's own court and then, after passing over or around the net assembly, touches directly the receiver's court.

2.6.4 From the start of service until it is struck, the ball shall be above the level of the playing surface and behind the server's end line, and it shall not be hidden from the receiver.

2.6.5 As soon as the ball has been projected, the server's free arm and hand shall be removed from the space between the ball and the net.

National byelaw 2.6.5(a): in domestic league play the referee may waive the free-arm requirement for players under twelve. This paragraph is a byelaw box and must be skipped by the scraper.

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2.9 A LET

2.9.1 The rally shall be a let if in service the ball, in passing over or around the net assembly, touches it, provided the service is otherwise correct or the ball is obstructed by the receiver.

2.9.2 The rally shall be a let if the service is delivered when the receiving player or pair is not ready, provided that neither the receiver nor the receiver's partner attempts to strike the ball.

2.9.3 The rally shall be a let if play is interrupted by the umpire or assistant umpire for any reason.

2.10 A POINT

2.10.1 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point if the opponent fails to make a correct

service.
2.10.2 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point if the opponent fails to make a correct return.
2.10.3 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point if, after the player has made a service or a return, the ball touches anything other than the net assembly before being struck by the opponent.
2.10.4 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point if the ball passes beyond the player's end line without touching the player's court, after being struck by the opponent.
2.10.5 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point if the opponent's free hand touches the playing surface during the rally.
2.10.6 Unless the rally is a let, a player shall score a point if the opponent, or anything the opponent wears or carries, touches the net assembly.

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2.11 A GAME
2.11.1 A game shall be won by the player or pair first scoring 15 points unless both players or pairs score 14 points, when the game shall be won by the first player or pair subsequently gaining a lead of 2 points.
2.13 THE ORDER OF SERVING
2.13.1 After each 3 points have been scored the receiving player or pair shall become the serving player or pair and so on until the end of the game, unless both players or pairs score 14 points, when the sequence of serving and receiving shall be the same but each player shall serve for only 1 point in turn.
2.13.2 The player or pair who served first in a game shall receive first in the next game of the match.

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2.14 EQUIPMENT CHECKS
2.14.1 Before a match the umpire shall inspect every racket. A racket may be of any size, shape or weight but the blade shall be flat and rigid. At least 85 percent of the blade by thickness shall be of natural wood; an adhesive layer within the blade may be reinforced with fibrous material such as carbon fibre, glass fibre or compressed paper, but shall not be thicker than 7.5 percent of the total thickness or 0.35 mm, whichever is the smaller. A side of the blade used for striking the ball shall be covered with either ordinary pimpled rubber, with pimples outwards having a total thickness including adhesive of not more than 2.0 mm, or sandwich rubber, with pimples inwards or outwards, having a total thickness including adhesive of not more than 4.0 mm. Ordinary pimpled rubber is a single layer of non-cellular rubber, natural or synthetic, with pimples evenly distributed over its surface at a density of not less than 10 per square centimetre and not more than 30 per square centimetre. Sandwich rubber is a single layer of cellular rubber covered with a single outer layer of ordinary pimpled rubber, the thickness of the pimpled rubber not being more than 2.0 mm. The covering material shall extend up to but not beyond the limits of the blade, except that the part nearest the handle and gripped by the fingers may be left uncovered or covered with any material. The blade, any layer within the blade and any layer of covering material or adhesive on a side used for striking the ball shall be continuous and of even thickness. The surface of the covering material on a side of the blade, or of a side of the blade if it is left uncovered, shall be matt, bright red on one side and black on the other. The racket covering shall be used without any physical, chemical or other treatment. Slight deviations from continuity of surface or uniformity of colour due to accidental damage or wear may be allowed provided that they do not significantly change the characteristics of the surface. Before the start of a match and whenever a player changes a racket during a match the player shall show the opponent and the umpire the racket that is about to be used and shall allow them to examine it. The umpire shall record the colours used and shall report any racket that fails inspection to the referee, who shall decide whether it may be used for the remainder of the match or must be replaced before play continues.
2.14.2 A ball shall be spherical, with a diameter of 42 mm, shall weigh 3.0 g and shall be made of celluloid or similar plastics material and shall be white or orange, and matt.